

STOP-COMMAND LEDGER

Public Record of Harm Signals, Stopping Authority, Continuation Decisions, and Preserved Benefits

The public record shows repeated moments when adult-controlled institutions could identify a child-facing harm, exercise a practical stop, and disclose the risk. At several of the clearest moments, the recorded choice preserved engagement, growth, reputation, payment access, virtual-gift revenue, or downstream remedial funding instead.

WHAT THIS LEDGER DOES	WHAT IT DOES NOT DO
Identifies the date, signal, receiver, available stop, recorded response, benefit, and proof status.	It does not treat allegations as verdicts, infer personal motive from institutional benefit, or require an individual child to prove a population-level stop opportunity.

Prepared by Stacey Kahns-Gray

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Starting rule

A stop command is counted only when the record supplies: (1) a recognizable harm signal, (2) an adult or institution with relevant control, and (3) a practical stopping option. Where direct receipt, dollar value, or motive is not proved, the ledger says so.

This is a public-record ledger, not legal advice or a final adjudication of liability.

Ledger findings

Earliest direct platform-knowledge anchor located	Snap's May 2012 corporate account of high-school students using the product throughout class.
Earliest named teacher warning located	Tracie Schroeder's May 1, 2014 public report of extreme classroom disruption after a Snapchat update.
Clearest school-hour stop conflict	Plaintiffs' 2025 discovery filing says TikTok declined default school-hour notification limits because they would reduce business metrics and daily active users.
Clearest sexualized monetization bridge	The same filing's Project Meramec account connects school-aged users, sexualized livestreaming, adult viewers, virtual gifts, and platform profit.
Clearest adult-content stop conflict	The FTC alleges Aylo's meaningful response followed payment-processor threats and that content teams resisted removals because competitors allowed the material.
Clearest K-12 remedy choice	Seattle Public Schools sought product changes and resources while expressly disavowing elimination; later MDL filings seek district-led fifteen-year plans and future costs.

Neutral synthesis

The evidence does not support a single undifferentiated accusation. Some teachers confiscated phones; some schools blocked access; districts sued; internal safety staff raised stop requests; regulators acted. But the same record repeatedly shows that the person or unit raising the stop signal did not control the full commercial system. Control remained with leadership, product, growth, procurement, payment, or remedy actors whose incentives differed.

That is the burden-transfer pattern: the platform retains the behavioral and monetary upside; the classroom, parent, child, or recovery community receives the operational burden; and the institutional remedy can then create a second funded system downstream. This is a structural inference from the listed records. It is not a finding that every participant acted corruptly or unlawfully.

Proof-status legend

A - direct public record	Official corporate, district, organization, or contemporaneous public statement.
B - court order	Court ruling. Its procedural scope controls; pleading-stage orders do not prove pleaded facts.
C - government complaint	Government pleading. Serious and citable, but allegations remain allegations unless admitted or adjudicated.
D - litigant discovery filing	Party filing summarizing discovery. Often detailed and exhibit-based, but disputed and not itself a finding.
E - stated inference	An inference stated separately from the underlying fact.

Chronological stop-command ledger

1. 2011 | Public demand-side return: NoFap

A - direct public record

HARM SIGNAL

NoFap states that its 2011 forum evolved when participants recognized struggles with pornography addiction and other compulsive sexual behavior.

RECEIVER / CONTROL

The signal was public and aggregate. The present record does not prove direct receipt by a named adult-content company or school district in 2011.

AVAILABLE STOP

Treat the return as a population warning; prevent child access and acquisition; preserve and test exposure-pathway data instead of requiring each child to self-identify.

RECORDED DECISION

No systemwide child non-access response to this signal is identified in the reviewed public record.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

Continued audience acquisition and traffic are plausible market benefits, but attribution to a particular firm from this signal alone would be inference, not fact.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

This proves an early public return signal, not prevalence, causation for every participant, or notice to a specific defendant.

Sources: S1

HARM SIGNAL

A Snap corporate post said the company was 'thrilled' that most surveyed users were high-school students using Snapchat to pass notes in class and send behind-the-back photographs of teachers throughout the day.

RECEIVER / CONTROL

Snap leadership and product teams; the knowledge came from Snap's own user outreach.

AVAILABLE STOP

End school-hour prompts and product optimization for classroom use; stop treating school penetration as growth; warn schools and parents.

RECORDED DECISION

The Nevada Attorney General alleges that Snap instead made young-user frequency and time spent a central goal and continued school-focused growth.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

Young-user frequency, time spent, and network growth. The quoted corporate statement is direct; the characterization of later strategy is an unadjudicated state allegation.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

This is the earliest direct platform-knowledge anchor located in this review. It is not presented as the first signal anywhere in the world.

Sources: S2

3. May 1-2, 2014 | Named teacher signal: Tracie Schroeder

A - direct public record

HARM SIGNAL

Schroeder publicly reported that, in sixteen years of teaching, nothing had disrupted her classroom more than the Snapchat update; students could not stay away, and one crawled under a table with a phone.

RECEIVER / CONTROL

The warning was public. The reviewed record does not establish who at Snap actually read it.

AVAILABLE STOP

Platform: withdraw or limit the disruptive feature and disable school-hour engagement. School: block access, preserve the incident, notify platform leadership, and demand a product-level stop.

RECORDED DECISION

The teacher confiscated phones; contemporaneous reporting noted a school block. Later filings allege Snap continued school marketing and declined school-hour restrictions.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

The school absorbed enforcement labor; the platform retained engagement and growth potential. A direct causal link between this specific warning and later corporate decisions is not established.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

This is the earliest named teacher warning located in the reviewed public record, not a claim that no earlier teacher complained.

Sources: S2, S3, S6

4. 2017-2018 | Meta - school penetration converted into growth

D - litigant discovery filing

HARM SIGNAL

The 2024 court order recounts allegations that high-penetration 'FB High Schools' produced 22% more time spent and that Meta used the formulation 'Winning Teens = Winning High Schools.'

RECEIVER / CONTROL

Meta product, growth, and leadership personnel; the underlying material is described as internal research.

AVAILABLE STOP

Stop school-by-school acquisition, default-disable school-hour engagement, and separate child safety from paid school access.

RECORDED DECISION

Plaintiffs' 2025 filing says Meta paid the National PTA \$110,000 and Scholastic \$135,000 in 2018 and used school and family channels to expand reach.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

More teen monthly active users and time spent; access to roughly 16,000 PTA presidents, 150,000 members, and school-family trust channels, as stated in plaintiffs' filing.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

The court order confirms what was pleaded and allowed some claims to proceed; it did not adjudicate the truth of every allegation. Payment figures come from plaintiffs' discovery brief.

Sources: S4, S6

5. 2020-2021 | TikTok - internal compulsive-use and school signal

C - government complaint

HARM SIGNAL

California alleges that a 2021 internal report shared with Boston Children's Hospital's Digital Wellness Lab found compulsive TikTok use 'rampant.' Other internal material described interference with school, sleep, and productivity.

RECEIVER / CONTROL

TikTok research, product, Trust and Safety, and policy teams.

AVAILABLE STOP

Default school-hour and bedtime notification restrictions; meaningful time limits; age assurance; warning to schools; independent publication of adverse findings.

RECORDED DECISION

The 2024 court order recounts TikTok's statement that it was prepared to implement product changes if needed, while later filings say school-hour notifications continued when restrictions threatened daily-active-user metrics.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

Daily active users, retention, time spent, advertiser trust, user loyalty, and brand stability.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

California's complaint and plaintiffs' filing are allegations based on cited internal material; the motion-to-dismiss order is not a merits verdict.

Sources: S4, S5, S6

6. October 26, 2021 onward | Named TikTok public representatives

C - government complaint

HARM SIGNAL

California's complaint identifies Michael Beckerman, then Vice President and Head of Public Policy, as testifying that TikTok shared responsibility with parents. It also identifies CEO Shou Chew and Senior Director of Public Policy Eric Ebenstein in later public/internal messaging about time-management tools.

RECEIVER / CONTROL

TikTok policy leadership and the public.

AVAILABLE STOP

State plainly whether safety tools materially reduce use; publish test results; make protections default; retain corporate responsibility rather than transferring the operational burden to parents and schools.

RECORDED DECISION

California alleges TikTok publicly promoted controls while internal evidence described some tools as useful talking points but not altogether effective.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

Reputation, regulatory defense, parent trust, and continued engagement while presenting safety activity.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

Naming a spokesperson proves a public representation, not personal control over every product decision or personal liability.

Sources: S5

7. Before 2021 through 2025 filing | TikTok - school-hour notification stop

D - litigant discovery filing

HARM SIGNAL

Plaintiffs' filing says TikTok's teams recognized that nighttime and school-hour notifications harmed sleep and academic performance and considered default restrictions.

RECEIVER / CONTROL

TikTok product and Trust and Safety teams, with the issue documented in internal analyses and testimony cited by plaintiffs.

AVAILABLE STOP

Disable notifications during ordinary school hours by default; warn schools and parents; make any override adult-controlled.

RECORDED DECISION

Plaintiffs state that TikTok declined because limits would harm business metrics and daily active users; one employee allegedly said the 'only reason' was priority.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

Daily active users, retention, session frequency, and notification-driven return.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

This is one of the clearest alleged signal-control-benefit conflicts, but it remains plaintiffs' summary of discovery unless and until admitted or found at trial.

Sources: S6

8. Early 2022 | TikTok LIVE - Project Meramec

D - litigant discovery filing

HARM SIGNAL

Plaintiffs' filing says TikTok's Project Meramec found school-aged and under-13 users livestreaming sexual or suggestive acts for adult viewers and virtual gifts convertible to money, with grooming and exploitation reflected in TikTok data.

RECEIVER / CONTROL

The project lead, Trust and Safety personnel, and senior executives to whom the concern was escalated; names are partly redacted in the public filing.

AVAILABLE STOP

Suspend minors from LIVE and gifting; close third-party age-gate bypasses; disable adult-to-minor monetization; warn schools and parents; publish the risk data.

RECORDED DECISION

Plaintiffs state that the project lead fought for months, that senior leaders knew, and that leadership refused to act; public warning followed press exposure rather than the internal stop request.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

LIVE engagement and virtual-gift revenue. Plaintiffs expressly contend that TikTok profited, but the public filing does not provide a verified dollar amount for this cohort.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

This is the strongest located bridge between school-aged users, sexualized conduct, adult demand, and platform monetization. It is a litigant's discovery account, not a final finding.

Sources: S6

9. 2022 | TikTok Now - pre-launch classroom warning

D - litigant discovery filing

HARM SIGNAL

Plaintiffs state that Trust and Safety warned TikTok Now's synchronized prompts would disrupt classrooms, that schools and teachers would hate it, and that minors already had smartphone addiction in class.

RECEIVER / CONTROL

TikTok product and Trust and Safety personnel before launch.

AVAILABLE STOP

Restrict the feature to adults; prevent school-hour prompts; delay launch until child-safety controls existed.

RECORDED DECISION

Plaintiffs say the recommendation was rejected because attraction to users under eighteen was the point and business growth was considered even with lower safety; post-launch data allegedly showed significant school-hour posting by ages 13-17.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

Competitive growth against BeReal, under-18 adoption, and synchronized engagement.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

This entry presents the filing's account of internal documents. It does not independently establish the intent of every TikTok employee.

Sources: S6

10. July 2022-March 2023 | TikTok - screen-time tool measured against retention

C - government complaint

HARM SIGNAL

California alleges leadership imposed guardrails so safety tools would not materially reduce use. Product Manager Lead Jiajia Li wrote that the goal was not to reduce time spent but to contribute to daily active users and retention.

RECEIVER / CONTROL

TikTok product leadership and screen-time-management teams.

AVAILABLE STOP

Measure success by material reduction in excessive minor use; make limits binding and adult-controlled; publish outcome metrics.

RECORDED DECISION

California alleges that a March 2023 test reduced average teen time only from about 108.7 to 107.1 minutes per day, while the tool was promoted publicly.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

Daily active users, retention, and public confidence without a large time-spent reduction.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

The quoted internal statements and test result appear in a government complaint and remain unadjudicated.

Sources: S5

11. January 6, 2023 | Seattle Public Schools - institutional activation

A - direct public record

HARM SIGNAL

Seattle Public Schools publicly aggregated platform-related student harm, operational disruption, and increased mental-health costs and filed suit.

RECEIVER / CONTROL

School board, district leadership, platform defendants, and the public.

AVAILABLE STOP

Use procurement, network, curriculum, preservation, and litigation authority to demand child non-access and product-level cessation; avoid replacing cessation with permanent student management.

RECORDED DECISION

SPS expressly said its goal was not to eliminate social media. It sought harmful-practice changes and additional resources for student mental-health needs.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

Institutional recovery and funded services. Its law firm is paid from any damages or settlement on contingency, not the district budget. No recovery is established by this source.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

Filing suit is a real upstream activation. The structural limit is equally direct: SPS chose reform plus resources, not elimination. This does not prove corrupt motive.

Sources: S7

12. October 24, 2024 | Federal court - school claims allowed in part

B - court order

HARM SIGNAL

The court summarized school allegations of deliberate youth-directed design, school-hour access, school targeting, operational disruption, and diverted resources.

RECEIVER / CONTROL

The court, platform defendants, plaintiff districts, and the public record.

AVAILABLE STOP

The record now supports testing product-level design, school targeting, warnings, and time-of-day controls without beginning from an individual child's diagnosis.

RECORDED DECISION

The court granted in part and denied in part the motion to dismiss, allowing much of the negligence theory to proceed while limiting claims under Section 230, the First Amendment, and intervening-cause rules.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

No party received damages from this order. The institutional benefit is legal viability and discovery access; the defendants retained defenses and claim limits.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

This order decides pleading-stage legal sufficiency, not whether the pleaded facts are true or whether any defendant is liable.

Sources: S4

13. 2012-2020; FTC filing in 2025 | Aylo/Pornhub - content warnings and payment threat

C - government complaint

HARM SIGNAL

The FTC alleges that Aylo distributed large quantities of child sexual abuse material and nonconsensual material; internal compliance described Pornhub as a 'goldmine' for rape content, and teams resisted removals.

RECEIVER / CONTROL

Compliance, Trust and Safety, tube-site operations, senior management, and payment processors, as alleged by the FTC.

AVAILABLE STOP

Remove and prevent re-upload; verify performers and consent; terminate uploaders across sites; stop monetizing suspect content; report as required.

RECORDED DECISION

The FTC alleges that meaningful action began only after Visa and Mastercard threatened termination and massive fines in early 2020, and even then compliance efforts were sometimes ignored or overruled.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

Content volume, competitive position, traffic, pay-site revenue, and continued payment processing. One internal email allegedly said removing problematic videos 'hurts us' when competitors allow them.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

These are FTC allegations resolved by stipulated order. The defendants neither admitted nor denied the complaint allegations except as stated in the order.

Sources: S8

14. November 21, 2025 filing | School-district MDL - fifteen-year remedy choice

D - litigant discovery filing

HARM SIGNAL

Plaintiffs' brief argues that platform harms pervade schools and supports district-led plans extending fifteen years, including services for students who may never have used a platform.

RECEIVER / CONTROL

Bellwether districts, their experts, the court, platform defendants, and prospective remedy administrators.

AVAILABLE STOP

Pair any recovery with enforceable product cessation, child non-access, disclosure, and non-substitution so intervention spending cannot replace stopping the pathway.

RECORDED DECISION

The districts seek future damages and abatement guided by Dr. Hoover's strategic plans and Dr. Leslie's cost analyses. The filing also lists claimed costs for monitoring and mental-health services.

BENEFIT PRESERVED OR SOUGHT

Examples claimed, not awarded: Breathitt \$47,468 for Hapara plus smaller monitoring costs; Tucson \$33,582 for Awareity and \$231,021 for Talkspace; Irvington lists several vendor amounts. The larger fifteen-year totals are not stated in the public brief text reviewed here.

NEUTRAL PROOF LIMIT

The plans may fund services genuinely used by students. The structural issue is remedy substitution: downstream services do not themselves stop upstream child reachability or monetization.

Sources: S6

Money and benefit ledger

Amounts below are labeled by transaction type. A payment is not proof of wrongdoing; a claimed cost is not an award; and an unquantified commercial benefit is not converted into a dollar figure.

Record	Amount or benefit	Status
Meta -> National PTA (2018)	\$110,000; part alleged to come from marketing	Plaintiffs' discovery filing; not a court finding
Meta -> Scholastic (2018)	\$135,000 for school/family outreach materials	Plaintiffs' discovery filing; not a court finding
TikTok notification restriction	Daily active users and business metrics preserved	Benefit named in plaintiffs' filing; no dollar amount
TikTok LIVE / virtual gifts	Virtual gifts convertible to money; alleged platform profit	Plaintiffs' filing; cohort dollars not public in reviewed text
Aylo content-removal resistance	Traffic/content volume, competitive position, and payment access	FTC allegation; no ledger dollar amount
Seattle Public Schools litigation	Damages/resources sought; counsel paid from recovery	Official district statement; no award established
Breathitt monitoring costs	\$47,468 Hapara; \$725 Eduspire; \$2,222 Securly	Percent-attributed claimed compensation in plaintiffs' filing
Tucson services	\$33,582 Awareity; \$231,021 Talkspace	40% compensation claimed in plaintiffs' filing
Irvington service vendors	\$325,147; \$624,917; \$226,467; \$19,770; \$58,160; \$146,136; \$66,086	20% compensation claimed; vendor totals listed in filing

What remains unquantified

The reviewed public filings do not expose a verified dollar value for school-hour notifications, the TikTok LIVE minor cohort, the full fifteen-year district plans, or the aggregate NoFap return signal. The ledger therefore records the benefit type and refuses to invent a number.

The strongest monetary evidence is not a profit total; it is the revealed choice architecture: when a stop threatened daily active users, competitive position, sponsorship reach, payment processing, or recoverable program costs, the record identifies who possessed the stopping lever and what was preserved.

Structural, legal, and moral reading

Structurally

The recurring pattern is separation of control from burden. Product and market actors control reachability, prompts, age gates, recommendation, monetization, and disclosure. Teachers, families, schools, moderators, and recovery communities receive the disruptive outputs. Later, litigation and service systems price the burden. A remedy that funds the receiver without disabling the sender can stabilize the same pathway it purports to address.

Legally

The 2024 MDL order permits substantial school negligence theories to proceed but is not a liability judgment. Government complaints and the 2025 opposition brief can support investigation, discovery demands, impeachment, notice theories, and control analysis, but their allegations must be proved or admitted. The clean legal use of this ledger is to identify custodians, documents, dates, available alternatives, benefit evidence, and contradictions - not to call every allegation established fact.

Morally and philosophically

Once adults can recognize that a child-facing system is producing compulsive classroom use, sleep interference, sexualized monetization, or a public recovery population, the moral burden shifts to the adults controlling access and design. A child should not have to generate more injury, disclose more intimate facts, or complete more intervention paperwork before the controlling actor uses an available stop.

Bottom line

The neutral conclusion is not that every school or company acted identically. It is that the public record contains multiple specific stop opportunities, and the most consequential decisions were made by adults who did not personally carry the resulting classroom, family, or recovery burden. Any credible remedy must therefore bind the stopping lever first and prevent intervention funding from substituting for cessation.

Source index

Each source is linked. Page references refer to the source PDF's printed or file page as stated. The source type controls the weight assigned in the ledger.

S1. NoFap, 'What is NoFap?' (official organization page; 2011 origin statement). [Open source](#)

S2. Nevada v. Snap Inc., Complaint, filed Jan. 30, 2024, especially pp. 24-26, paras. 57-65 (state allegations quoting Snap's 2012 corporate post and the 2014 teacher report). [Open source](#)

S3. Ellis Hamburger, 'Teens are going completely bananas for the new Snapchat,' The Verge, May 2, 2014 (Tracie Schroeder's May 1 public report). [Open source](#)

S4. In re Social Media Adolescent Addiction/Personal Injury Products Liability Litigation, 754 F. Supp. 3d 946 (N.D. Cal. Oct. 24, 2024), order granting in part and denying in part the school-district defendants' motion to dismiss. [Open source](#)

S5. People of the State of California v. TikTok Inc. et al., unredacted complaint, filed Oct. 8, 2024, especially pp. 36, 46, 48-49, and 68-69. [Open source](#)

S6. Plaintiffs' Omnibus Opposition to Defendants' Motions for Summary Judgment, In re Social Media MDL No. 3047, Dkt. 2480, filed Nov. 21, 2025, especially pp. 28-30, 94-96, 119-127, 208-210, and 216-227. [Open source](#)

S7. Seattle Public Schools, 'Social Media Complaint Filed by Seattle Public Schools,' Jan. 6, 2023 (official district explanation, remedy statement, and contingency disclosure). [Open source](#)

S8. FTC v. Aylo Group Ltd. et al., Complaint, filed Sept. 3, 2025, especially pp. 3-5, 23, 28, and 37-39; see FTC official case page for complaint and stipulated order. [Open source](#)

Citation discipline

S2, S5, and S8 are government complaints. S6 is a plaintiffs' opposition brief summarizing cited discovery. S4 is a court order deciding a motion to dismiss and expressly summarizes alleged facts. S1, S3, and S7 are direct public statements or contemporaneous reports. Those categories are not interchangeable.

Version note

This first public-record ledger begins from the pasted sixteen-source synthesis and adds independently obtained public sources. It is designed to be folded into the synthesis without reopening its entry, measurement, category-control, or no-individualization findings.